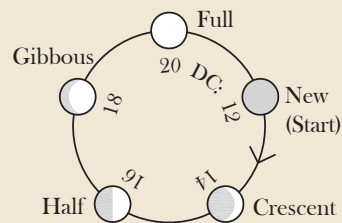


A CYCLE UNBROKEN



Moon Phase Progression:

As the party delves deeper and the ritual progresses, the moon phase advances.

Difficulty Classes increase and spells' strength, range/area, and duration are affected. Spellcasters will immediately feel these effects.

New: No magic

Crescent: 1/2 x magic

Half: Normal magic

Gibbous: 1 1/2 x magic

Full: 2 x magic

Soon after the Order of the Glorious Secant moved into an abandoned holdfast in the Scatterfall Mountains, townsfolk and travelers started to go missing, livestock became afflicted with a wasting disease, and the moon's phases became unpredictable. The Order is attempting to fix the moon in its full phase, an aberration against the proper function of the universe.

- **A**: Entry Bridge: if the party tarries too long the Rock Scorpions who nest on the underside will investigate. The scorpions will not enter area B.
- **B**: The Gate-Circle: passing through the large gate will trigger necrotic damage if the Cult Symbol is not presented. Circumventing the main gate requires a modest climbing skill check. Each other gate is carved with one of the phases of the moon. The New Moon gate is seeping milky fluid (the remaining gates will also seep as the moon phase advances). The spiral stair-well is steep and slippery. Optional: Cultists are hiding behind the half-moon gate and will attempt to push the PCs down the stairwell.
- **C**: Entry Hall: a Wolfbat waits in the shadowy alcove. It will attack any non-cultists who enter. If combat goes poorly it will flee up the stairs to A and then fly to area I. The floor tiles of the Wolfbat's alcove conceal a shaft to area I. Light is provided by wall-mounted Moonstones (will glow for 6 hours in darkness, can be recharged by exposure to moonlight for a full night).
- **D**: Cleansing Chamber: The door to this chamber is locked. A spring-fed trough here is used for ritual ablutions. Covered in sediment at the bottom of the trough is a Cult Symbol and a valuable bracelet. Hanging on the wall are several cultist robes.
- **E**: Bas-relief: a carving on the wall depicts a moth-headed lunar god. The mandibles of the god can be removed and are the key to the Ark in area G (only evident with careful searching).
- **F**: Chapel: several Cultists and a Cult Priest (spellcaster with a magical dagger of life-drain) are conducting a ceremony of moon-worship. Anyone entering who is not wearing robes will be immediately attacked. Even robed, anyone with unclean hands will be found out if they come within 5' of any cultmember. On the altar is a goblet of spider venom — the priest is immune.
- **G**: Library: among other books a glass Ark containing the high holy text of the Order. The ark will release moth-powder (save or sleep, lethargy on a successful save) unless opened with the key from area E or the lock is successfully picked. If opened without the key the Cultists from area F will enter and attack (if alive). The book is quite valuable to the right collector. Behind a stack of books on zoology is a secret passage to area I.
- **H**: Sacrifice Preparation: two Cult Priests are milking the venom from a Phase Spider. All three will attack any intruders and will not be fooled by cultist robes. Two poisoned townsfolk are bound and gagged in the corner.
- **I**: Bat Cavern: A colony of Bats lives here in total darkness along with three Giant Bats. If disturbed (loud noise, bright light) or warned by the Wolfbat they attack; bites require a constitution save to avoid Wasting Sickness (gain a level of exhaustion immediately and save again every hour - cured on success, another level on fail). A tunnel leads to the outside (a perilous climb). Optional: yard-long Guano Worms infest the litter on the cave floor.
- **J**: Cultist Roost: several Cultists and Cult Priests sleep here, suspended from the ceiling. The floor of this dark room is strewn with empty venom-goblets - if kicked over the cultists will awaken and attack. The goblets are of silver and opal (valuable).
- **K**: Ritual Chamber: a poisoned townsman is suspended head-down over a spherical glass vessel which catches spider-venom leaking from his eyes. Two Cult Priests and a Lunar Wolf observe. Disrupting this ritual stops the advancing moon phases. Emptying the vessel sets the moon phase to New Moon.
- **L**: Lair of Loris Monaraktyon, leader of the Order. She is a spellcaster and multi-lycanthropic, able to shift at will between human, Lunar Wolf, and Giant Bat form. She wields a life-draining longsword and wears bracers of defense.



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